PROJECT 10073 RECORD CARD

1. DATE
16 Jan 58

2. LOCATION
Trinidade. Island

3. DATE-TIME GROUP
Local 1200
GMT

4. TYPE OF OBSERVATION
☒ Ground-Visual
☐ Ground-Radar
☐ Air-Visual
☐ Air-Intercept Radar

5. PHOTOS
☒ Yes
☐ No

6. SOURCE
Military

7. LENGTH OF OBSERVATION
unknown

8. NUMBER OF OBJECTS
one

9. COURSE
unknown

10. BRIEF SUMMARY OF SIGHTING
Two leading newspapers in Rio De Janeiro printed photos of alleged "flying saucers" photographed fm a Brazilian naval ship.

11. COMMENTS
Upon investigation the Brazilian Navy refused to make an official statement, and this Center has been unable to obtain copies of the photos. Analysis at ONI is that p photos are hoax.

12. CONCLUSIONS
☐ Was Balloon
☐ Probably Balloon
☐ Possibly Balloon
☐ Was Aircraft
☐ Probably Aircraft
☐ Possibly Aircraft
☐ Was Astronomical
☐ Probably Astronomical
☐ Possibly Astronomical
☒ Other Hoax
☐ Insufficient Data for Evaluation
☐ Unknown

ATIC FORM 329 (REV 26 SEP 52)

TRINDADE ISLAND

1958

The Air Force received its information on this case from the U. S. Navy; it evaluated the photographs as a "trick."

Although a detailed investigation was not undertaken by the Navy, the photographs furnished by the Brazilian navy were reviewed and found to be unconvincing. Land details are extremely sharp, but the disc is hazy, has little contrast, and shows no shadow effect. It also appears the object is inverted in one photograph when compared with the other two photos. Also, the photographer mentioned extremely high velocities, and there appears to be no lateral blurring as would occur with any reasonable shutter speed.

The man who made these pictures had no connection with the Brazilian navy; he was a professional photographer, noted particularly as an expert in trick photography. No member of the Brazilian navy reported seeing the UFO; in addition to the photographer, only two persons, both of them friends of the photographer, reported seeing the UFO.

This sighting is still carried as a TRICK in Air Force files.

OFFICIAL FILE COPY

AFCIN-4E2x /Maj Friend/amc/69216/typed 27 July 60 1 AUG 1960

ONI Information Report (Flying Saucer Photographed from Almirante Saldanha)

SAFOI-3d (L/Col Tacker)

1. Attached are copies of the ONI Information Report, subject: "Brazil - Navy - Flying Saucer Photographed from Almirante Saldanha," dated 11 March 1958. This report was requested by L/Col Tacker of SAFOI-3d on 26 July 1960.

2. This report is unclassified. The report is on a standard Navy form with Confidential stamps; however, the word "unclassified" has been typed across the classification box by the office of origin.

FOR THE COMMANDER:

Nicholas Post 7/29/60

PHILIP G. EVANS
Colonel, USAF
Deputy for Science and Components

1 Atch:
Cy ONI Info Rpt, dtd 11 Mar 58

COORDINATION:

AFCIN-4E2x Robert J Friend Maj Date 27 July 60

AFCIN-4E2 RRShoop Col Date 27 July 60

[redacted] GLF

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INFORMATION REPORT
OFFICE OF NAVAL INTELLIGENCE

OPNAV FORM 3920-2 (REV. 5-50)

CLASSIFICATION ~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

DATE OF INFORMATION 21-27 Feb 1958

SERIAL NO. 39-58

DATE OF REPORT 11 March 1958

FROM U.S. Naval Attaché, Rio de Janeiro

SOURCE ~~Contact~~ Press

EVALUATION B-3

REQUEST NO.

SUBJECT BRAZIL - Navy - Flying Saucer Photographed from ALMIRANTE SALDANHA

BRIEF (FOR REPORTS OF MORE THAN ONE PAGE, ENTER CAREFUL SUMMARY)

IFI Nº 9600.

Encl: (1) Set of 4 Brazilian Navy photographs of subject

1. Announcement. On 21 February 1958, two of the leading newspapers in Rio de Janeiro printed photographs showing alleged flying saucer photographed from Brazilian naval ship, ALMIRANTE SALDANHA, at approximately midday on 16 January 1958 while the ship was anchored off Trindade Island some 600 miles east of Rio de Janeiro. The ship at the time was engaged in research as part of Brazilian Navy participation in the International Geophysical Year.

2. Photographer. The photographs themselves were taken by a free lance photographer, [redacted], using his Rolleiflex camera set at speed 125., lens opening 8, and were developed in a laboratory in ALMIRANTE SALDANHA. This gentleman has a long history of photographic trick shots and is well known for such items as false pictures of treasure on the ocean floor. Another time he prepared a purposely humorous article, published in a magazine, entitled "A Flying Saucer Hunted Me at Home", using trick photography. [redacted], after the release of his latest "flying saucer" photographs, told the press that the Navy secret service had interrogated him for four hours concerning his photos. "The negatives were projected in large size on a screen. If there was any trick, the gigantic projection would have revealed it. After questioning by officers of the Estado-Maior, the Chief of the Secret Service, the senior officer present said to me, 'I am going to ask you a few [redacted]s. Don't be

ORDER PHOTOS BY ONI NOS. 1322108 THRU 1322111.

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CLASSIFICATION
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	Commerce		ComNavPhil		BuSandA		OP37		F3	1	GB1 (AG)	
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0	USCG		Com2NDFlt		BuAer		OP41	1	H1	1	G4	40-4
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	SecNav		ComServ6Flt		BuMed		OP55		H3M			I.R.
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	ASPPA		ComMinPac		BuPers		OP61		N1			
	OASD		ComMinLant		NOL		OP62		N2			~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
					NEL		OP63		N3			
		[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]			1	V			

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PNAV FORM 3820-2 (C) (REV. 6-55)

CLASS	FROM	REPORT NO.	DATE
CONFIDENTIAL	U.S. Naval Attaché, Rio	39-58	11 March 1958

offended because I don't doubt the authenticity of your photos but I need to hear from you. If you were going to make a flying saucer appear on a negative, how would you proceed?' Comandante, I am an able photographer specialized in trick photography but not one would withstand close and accurate examination."

3. Brazilian Navy Stand. Immediately after the photographs of the flying saucer were publicized, the Brazilian Navy refused to make any official statement confirming or denying the incident. However, proofs from the original negatives were sent to the other armed forces and to the President via an officer-messenger who related the complete story. According to the press, the narration so impressed Mr. [redacted] that he became convinced of the veracity of the happening.

On 24 February, three days after the photos were first published in the press, the Navy Ministry finally made an official statement: "With reference to the reports appearing in the press that the Navy is opposed to divulge the facts concerning the appearance of a strange object over Trindade Island, this Cabinet declares that such information has no basis. This Ministry has no motive to impede the release of photographs of the referred to object taken by [redacted] who was at Trindade Island at the invitation of the Navy, and in the presence of a large number of the crew of ALMIRANTE SALDANHA from whose deck the photographs were taken. Clearly, this Ministry will not be able to make any pronouncement concerning the object seen because the photographs do not constitute sufficient proof for such purpose."

4. Statements of SALDANHA Personnel. On the morning after the photos of the flying saucer were published in the press (February 22), the ALMIRANTE SALDANHA departed Rio to continue its mission in connection with the IGY. Two days later, however, the ship docked at Santos (February 24) for voyage repairs and this was the first chance that newspapermen had an opportunity to interview officers and men aboard. The Assistant Naval Attaché was in Santos at this time in connection with the visit of USCGC WESTWIND (Alusna Rio IR 36-58 of 10 March) and had an opportunity to visit aboard. The commanding officer, Capitao-de-Mar-e-Guerra (CAPT) José Santos Saldanha da Gama, had not seen the object and was noncommittal. The executive officer also had not seen it but, arriving shortly thereafter, had formed the opinion that those on deck had seen it. The captain had reported that his secretary, a LCDR, had seen it but this officer when personally questioned avoided discussing the matter. Later, it was learned that the photographer was accompanied to the dark room by an officer who waited outside the door while [redacted] developed the negatives alone.

At the time of the official visit of the commanding officer of WESTWIND to ALMIRANTE SALDANHA, Captain Saldanha da Gama freely discussed the flying saucer and showed the original proofs to the callers but again did not commit himself.

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INFORMATION REPORT

OPNAV FORM 3820-2 (C) (REV. 6-55)

CLASSIFICATION	FROM	REPORT NO.	DATE
[redacted]	U.S. Naval Attaché, Rio	39-58	11 March 195

5. Publicity. The press reports after the publication of the photographs covered a great deal of newspaper space for about a week, tending to prove or disprove the authenticity of [redacted] photographs. DIARIO CARIOCA reported that personnel of SALDANHA were under rigid orders of silence. O GLOBO published a story with photographs by photographer, [redacted], of flying saucers (china) taken at Cabo Frio.

Federal Deputy Sergio Magalhães sent a note to the Navy Ministry on 27 February protesting the Navy's failure to secure sworn statements of witnesses. "For the first time in flying saucer history, the phenomenon was attended by large numbers of persons belonging to a military force which give these latest photographs an official stamp. Threats to national security require greater official attention and action," said the Deputy. In the middle of all the publicity, other "flying saucer" sighting reports came out including a naval officer who saw a flying saucer a month before sighting from SALDANHA off the coast of Espirito Santo. CO and crew of ATA TRIDENTE saw flying saucer several days before SALDANHA sighting but kept information secret.

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ORMATION REPORT

AV FORM 3820-2 (C) (REV. 8-55)

ASSIFICATION	FROM	REPORT NO.	DATE
CONFIDENTIAL	U.S. Naval Attaché, Rio	39-58	11 March 195

Preparing Officer's Comments:

1. Most flying saucer stories are not worth wasting much time or effort, but this story apparently substantiated by official Navy photographs taken in the presence of large number of Navy personnel under closely controlled and almost ideal circumstances should have absolutely proved the existence of an unidentified flying object. Unfortunately, further investigation provided only frustration at every turning. A number of Brazilian Navy officers profess to believe the story implicitly but whether they have more information than we is unknown.

2. There appear to be only two explanations for this peculiar incident:

(a) Some overwhleming power has told the Brazilian Navy not to officially verify this incident (which they should easily be able to do, if it occurred) nor to deny it (which they should easily be able to do, if it is a fake). I personally do not believe that anyone has told the Brazilian Navy to keep quiet about it because there has been no hint of such suppression in either Brazilian or U.S. circles; and also because I doubt their control of the individual officers and men is good enough to hold the line.

(b) The whole thing is a fake publicity stunt put on by a crooked photographer and the Brazilian Navy fell for it. This seems like the most likely considering Brazilian's love for sensationalism and gossip, their well known propensity for never letting the truth stand in the way of a good story, and general bureaucratic inefficiency.

3. In addition, the photographs furnished by the Brazilian Navy are unconvincing. Details of the land are extremely sharp but the disc is hazy and has little contrast and shows no shadow effect. It also appears that the object was inverted in photograph 2 compared to 1 and 3. Also the papers have mentioned extremely high velocities and there appears to be no lateral blurring as would occur with any reasonable shutter speed.

4. It is the reporting officer's private opinion that a flying saucer sighting would be unlikely at the very barren island of Trindade, as everyone knows Martians are extremely comfort loving creatures.

Prepared and forwarded:

M. SUNDERLAND
CAPT, USN

[redacted]

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